GLOBAL MENTORSHIP INITIATIVE

Session 5
Why SMART Goals are Important

SMART Goals

When you meet with your mentor for your discussion about the professional skills required to be successful, think about how these will apply in your chosen profession. These include hard skills, which are the ones needed for your specific job like accounting or software development.

However, we will focus more on the soft skills needed to succeed in business regardless of your profession. Self-reflection will help you determine the soft skills that you should further develop before starting your career job.

Your mentor may have some examples of how soft skills have impacted careers of people in the workplace. I encourage you to have an open and honest discussion with your mentor about the skills you may need to work on so that you make the best first impression at your new job. Soft skills will affect your promotability throughout your career.

You will also talk about SMART goals. These are very important not just for your personal aspirations, but SMART goals are used every day in the corporate world to set budgets and operational strategy.

You should become proficient with SMART goals now because in job interviews when you mention how you use SMART goals today, you will distinguish yourself from the other candidates as someone who understands how business works and that you possess the discipline required for effective personal goal setting.

